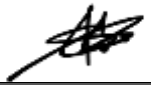
	DECLARATION OF PERSONNEL COMPETENCE TECHNICAL SIGNATORY		
	Document no: **ASMF 6.2 PROCEDURE**		
	Compiled by:	**Sifiso Nyambi- Laboratory Manager**	
	Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**	

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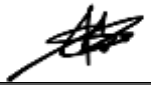
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Approval of Technical Signatories

1. Purpose

To define the criteria and process for the approval, authorization, and ongoing monitoring of Technical Signatories responsible for the review and authorization of laboratory results and reports.

2. Definition

A Technical Signatory (TS) is a staff member authorized by Azuresky (Pty) Ltd to technically review, validate and approve test results and reports prior to release.

3. Minimum Requirements for Appointment as Technical Signatory

Personnel nominated as Technical Signatories shall meet the following minimum requirements:

3.1 Technical Knowledge and Experience

The individual shall demonstrate:
• knowledge of all test methods for which they will be authorized to sign (e.g. ash, volatile matter, calorific value, MIAS, sample preparation),
• understanding of relevant laboratory procedures and quality controls,
• knowledge of calculations, conversions, units, significant figures and result evaluation applicable to the test methods.

3.2 Knowledge of Standards and Accreditation Requirements

The individual shall demonstrate:
• understanding of ISO/IEC 17025:2017 requirements,
• knowledge of applicable method standards (ISO, SANS, ASTM as relevant),
• knowledge of SANAS R-series documents and applicable technical criteria,
• understanding of the laboratory's management system and reporting requirements.

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3.3 Management Endorsement

Appointment of a Technical Signatory shall be subject to:
• recommendation by the Laboratory Manager or Quality Manager, and
• formal endorsement by upper management and/or the Board of Directors.

No individual shall act as a Technical Signatory without documented management approval.

4. Competence Assessment of Technical Signatories

4.1 Initial Assessment

Before authorization, each Technical Signatory shall be assessed by the laboratory to confirm competence. Assessment activities may include:
• written or oral evaluation of method knowledge,
• demonstration of practical competence,
• evaluation of calculation accuracy and result interpretation,
• review of knowledge of ISO/IEC 17025 and SANAS requirements,
• supervised review and approval of test results.

4.2 Authorization Scope

Technical Signatories shall be authorized only for specific test methods or groups of methods for which competence has been demonstrated.
The authorized scope shall be documented in a Technical Signatory Authorization Register.

4.3 Ongoing Monitoring and Reassessment

Technical Signatory competence shall be monitored through:
• internal audits,
• result review performance,
• proficiency testing performance,
• periodic reassessment as defined by the laboratory.

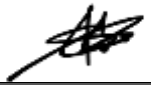
Reassessment shall be conducted when:
• methods change,
• significant nonconformities occur,
• new standards are introduced, or
• performance concerns are identified.

5. Responsibilities of Technical Signatories

Technical Signatories are responsible for:
• verifying that test methods were correctly applied,
• ensuring calculations and conversions are correct,
• confirming quality control requirements were met,
• ensuring results are technically valid before authorization,
• ensuring reports comply with standard and customer requirements,
• ensuring no unauthorized claims of accreditation or conformity are made.

6. Records

The following records shall be maintained:
• Technical Signatory qualification and training records,
• competence assessment results,
• management approval and endorsement records,
• Technical Signatory Authorization Register,
• reassessment and monitoring records.

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